# Git Game

Print-and-play, deck v0.2 · for playtesting · the name is not final

## What's in this file

- 60 commit cards and 33 command cards — shuffle these together into one draw deck.
- 8 incident cards — a separate face-down pile.
- 6 secret tickets — deal one to each player, face down.
- 4 optional role cards — deal one each, or leave them out for your first game.
- 1 initial-commit card, a reference sheet, and a token sheet.
- 13 card pages at 9 cards per page. Print single-sided on thick paper, or sleeve the cards with opaque backs: face-down cards must not be readable through the paper.

## Setup

- Put the initial-commit card in the middle of the table. This is the start of main.
- Give each player a pointer token and place it on the initial commit. Everyone starts up to date.
- Shuffle commit and command cards together. Deal 5 cards to each player.
- Deal one secret ticket to each player. Shuffle the incident pile.
- Release: the game ends when main has this many commits — 2 players: 10, 3: 12, 4–5: 15 — or when someone plays git tag v1.0 at that point.
- Keep merge, grudge and sin tokens in the middle. Cut them from the token sheet or use coins.

## Playtesting

The rules live in docs/design/base-rules.md and this deck in rules/deck.json. After a game, write down: what was tense, what was boring, where the rules were unclear, and who won and why. That report is the most valuable thing this deck can produce.

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# Turn reference

## Your turn

1. Draw 2 cards (new tickets came in).
2. Spend 3 ops, in any order.
3. Say a real commit message out loud when you commit. "fix", "wip" or "asdf" draws a bug.
4. Holding more than 10 cards? Discard down to 10.

## Ops

git add (1) — move any number of hand cards to your staging area, face down.

git commit (1) — all staged cards become ONE commit on your local branch.

git push (1) — move your local commits onto the end of main. Rejected if your pointer is not at the tip. The op is still spent.

git pull (1) — move your pointer to the tip. If you had unpushed commits, take a merge token (-1 at release); with none it is a fast-forward: no token.

git pull --rebase (2) — same, no merge token.

play a command card (its printed cost).

## Merge conflicts

When you pull, if any of your unpushed commits touches the same file as a commit you're pulling in, you have a conflict. Choose:

ours — keep yours; their commit is flipped and crossed out, its author loses those lines and gives you a grudge token (-1 at release).

theirs — discard your commit.

resolve (+1 op) — keep both.

## The commit-size gamble

One big commit scores its lines all at once but costs one op. If one card inside is a bug and it is blamed, the whole commit takes the penalty. Small commits are safe and slow.

## Bugs and blame

About one card in five is a bug. It is printed on the face; only the holder knows. You may push it.

git blame flips a commit. A bug costs its author -3 on the spot. A bug hidden in a squashed commit costs -5.

revert neutralises a face-up bug: it no longer counts at release. +1 for the fixer.

## Release (CI)

When main reaches the target size, anyone may play git tag v1.0 (1 op). Flip every commit on main. Each bug: -3 to its author.

If 4 or more bugs reached production, the release fails: the player with the LEAST blame wins.

Otherwise: lines shipped - blame - merge tokens - grudges - sins + secret ticket.

## Incidents

Flip one incident at the start of every round (before the first player's turn). It applies to everyone this round.

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+1

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+3

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+3

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+5

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+5

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+7

lines

COMMIT Git Game

auth.js

+8

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+1

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+3

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+3

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+5

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+5

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+7

lines

COMMIT Git Game

api.py

+8

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+1

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+3

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+3

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+5

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+5

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+7

lines

COMMIT Git Game

styles.css

+8

lines

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+1

lines

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+3

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

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Dockerfile

+3

lines

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

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lines

COMMIT Git Game

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COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+7

lines

COMMIT Git Game

Dockerfile

+8

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+1

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+2

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+3

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+3

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+4

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

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COMMIT Git Game

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BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+7

lines

COMMIT Git Game

README.md

+8

lines

COMMAND Git Game

## git blame

Flip one commit on main. If it holds a bug, its author takes -3 blame now. The commit stays face-up.

cost: 1 op

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COMMAND Git Game

## git bisect

Point at a range of main. If any bug is in it, its owner must say which half it is in. Halve until found, then flip it: -3 to its author.

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**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## cherry-pick

Copy one commit from main onto your local branch (use a spare card as the copy). The original author stays the author, including for blame.

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**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## push --force

Overwrite main with your local branch. Every commit after your pointer is erased and goes back to its owner's local branch. Take a Sin token.

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Overwrite main with your local branch. Every commit after your pointer is erased and goes back to its owner's local branch. Take a Sin token.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## `reflog`

Play at any time, even on someone else's turn, right after a push --force: the erased commits come back on top of main. Free to play.

**cost: free**

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Play at any time, even on someone else's turn, right after a push --force: the erased commits come back on top of main. Free to play.

**cost: free**

COMMAND Git Game

## `revert`

Choose a face-up bug on main. Put this card on top of it as a revert: it no longer counts as a bug at release. +1 for you.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

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Choose a face-up bug on main. Put this card on top of it as a revert: it no longer counts as a bug at release. +1 for you.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## stash

Set up to 3 cards from your hand aside, face down. They are safe from any discard effect. Take them back for free on a later turn.

**cost: 1 op**

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Set up to 3 cards from your hand aside, face down. They are safe from any discard effect. Take them back for free on a later turn.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## commit --amend

Swap one card in your last unpushed commit with a card from your hand. On a commit that is already on main: +1 Sin.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

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Swap one card in your last unpushed commit with a card from your hand. On a commit that is already on main: +1 Sin.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## rebase -i

Squash two or more of your unpushed commits into one. +2 lines for clean history. A bug found inside a squashed commit costs -5 instead of -3.

**cost: 1 op**

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**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## `checkout <sha>`

Target a player. They are in Detached HEAD: their next commit is discarded unless they first spend 1 op on git switch -c.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## `checkout <sha>`

Target a player. They are in Detached HEAD: their next commit is discarded unless they first spend 1 op on git switch -c.

**cost: 1 op**

COMMAND Git Game

## `checkout <sha>`

Target a player. They are in Detached HEAD: their next commit is discarded unless they first spend 1 op on git switch -c.

**cost: 1 op**

INCIDENT Git Game

## Friday Deploy

Everyone must push this round. Anyone who doesn't loses 1 op next round.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT Git Game

## left-pad Unpublished

Every Dockerfile commit on main becomes a bug. Flip them face-up now.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT Git Game

## Merge Freeze

Nobody can push this round.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT Git Game

## Flaky CI

The next push this round rolls a die. On 1 or 2 it is rejected; the op is spent.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT Git Game

## Standup Ran Long

Everyone has 2 ops this round instead of 3.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT Git Game

## Stack Overflow Is Down

No command cards this round.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT — Git Game

## Hackathon

Everyone has 4 ops this round.

**flip one at the start of each round**

INCIDENT — Git Game

## Security Audit

Going around the table, each player flips one commit on main that is not their own. Blame applies.

**flip one at the start of each round**

SECRET TICKET — Git Game

## Linear History Purist

Finish the game with zero merge tokens.

**+3 at release · keep hidden**

SECRET TICKET — Git Game

## Owns Auth

Have three auth.js commits on main at release.

**+3 at release · keep hidden**

SECRET TICKET — Git Game

## Release Manager

Be the player who tags v1.0.

**+3 at release · keep hidden**

SECRET TICKET — Git Game

## Chaos Agent

At release, each of your bugs on main scores +3 for you instead of -3.

**+3 at release · keep hidden**

SECRET TICKET — Git Game

## Documentation Hero

Have three README.md commits on main at release.

**+3 at release · keep hidden**

SECRET TICKET — Git Game

## Small Batches

Never make a commit with more than one card in it.

**+3 at release · keep hidden**

ROLE (OPTIONAL) — Git Game

## The Intern

Once per game, push without being up to date. Start with 2 extra cards. The first blame against you is ignored: they're learning.

**deal one per player, or skip roles**

ROLE (OPTIONAL) Git Game

## The Rebase Zealot

pull --rebase costs you 1 op. Plain pull costs you 2.

**deal one per player, or skip roles**

ROLE (OPTIONAL) Git Game

## The Senior Reviewer

Once per round, secretly peek at any face-down commit on main.

**deal one per player, or skip roles**

ROLE (OPTIONAL) Git Game

## The 10x Dev

You have 4 ops per turn. Every commit you make must hold at least 3 cards.

**deal one per player, or skip roles**

MAIN Git Game

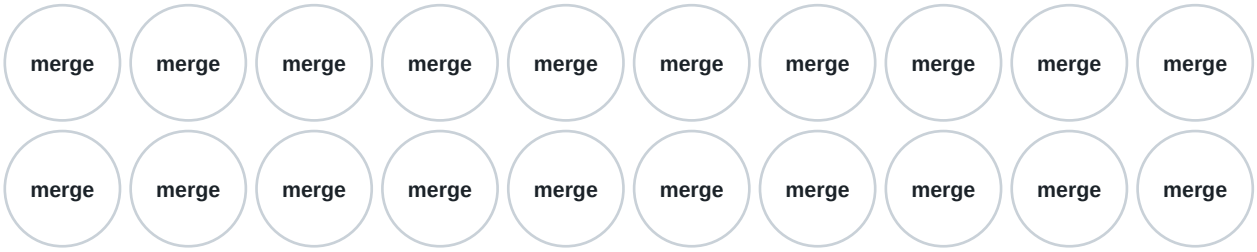
`initial commit`

start of main · everyone's pointer begins here

# Tokens

Cut along the lines, or use coins, paper clips and dice instead. Pointer tokens go on main; one color per player.

### merge (-1)




### grudge (-1)

### sin (-1)

### pointer tokens (2 per player)